Orthopaedics Service Line Handbook

MERIDIAN HEALTH PARTNERS ## Orthopaedics Department Service Line Handbook Document ID: MHP-ORTH-HB-042 Effective Date: 1 January 2025 Owner: Dr. Aris Thorne, Chief Medical Officer Applies To: All 14 Meridian Health Partners outpatient sites

SECTION 1: PURPOSE AND SCOPE

1.1 This handbook establishes the operational, scheduling, and insurance administration protocols for the Orthopaedics department across all 14 Meridian Health Partners outpatient facilities.

1.2 Referral turnaround times are governed exclusively by the Meridian Referral Management Policy (MHP-REF-001); staff shall consult that document rather than apply local turnaround rules.

SECTION 2: APPOINTMENT SCHEDULING AND ACCESS COMMITMENTS

2.1 First Appointment Access Commitment: The Orthopaedics department commits to offering a first appointment within 10 days of an accepted referral.

2.2 Standard Consultation Duration: The standard new-patient consultation is 30 minutes.

2.3 Service Durations: Individual orthopaedic services are strictly time-allocated as follows:
- `ORTH-CONS` Orthopaedics Consultation: 30 minutes
- `ORTH-MRI` MRI Knee: 45 minutes
- `ORTH-ARTH` Knee Arthroscopy: 75 minutes

SECTION 3: CONDITIONS ACCEPTED AND EXPLICITLY NOT ACCEPTED

3.1 Accepted Conditions: The department accepts referrals for acute and chronic musculoskeletal conditions of the knee, routine sports injuries, and diagnostic evaluations corresponding to listed service codes.

3.2 Explicitly Not Accepted: The department does not accept referrals for spinal surgeries, pediatric orthopaedics (patients under 18 years of age), or tertiary oncology cases. Unaccepted referrals shall be redirected in accordance with the Referral Management Policy.

SECTION 4: PATIENT PREPARATION INSTRUCTIONS

4.1 Patients scheduled for `ORTH-CONS` (Orthopaedics Consultation) must bring all prior imaging films, diagnostic reports, and a complete medication list to the facility.

4.2 Patients scheduled for `ORTH-MRI` (MRI Knee) must complete the Meridian MRI Safety Screening Form 24 hours prior to arrival and remove all metallic objects, jewelry, and non-permanent hardware before entering the scan room.

4.3 Patients scheduled for `ORTH-ARTH` (Knee Arthroscopy) must observe a strict nil-per-os (NPO) fasting protocol starting 8 hours prior to the procedure time and arrange a responsible adult escort for discharge transport.

SECTION 5: PROCEDURE CODES, LIST PRICES, AND PLAN COVERAGE MATRIX

5.1 `ORTH-CONS` | Orthopaedics Consultation (Consultation | List Price: $200 | Duration: 30 minutes)
- MERIDIAN-GOLD: Covered; no pre-authorisation required.
- MERIDIAN-SILVER: Covered; no pre-authorisation required.
- MERIDIAN-BRONZE: Covered; no pre-authorisation required.
- CIVIC-BASE: Covered; no pre-authorisation required.

5.2 `ORTH-MRI` | MRI Knee (Imaging | List Price: $1,400 | Duration: 45 minutes)
- MERIDIAN-GOLD: Covered; no pre-authorisation required.
- MERIDIAN-SILVER: Covered; pre-authorisation required in 3 business days.
- MERIDIAN-BRONZE: Covered; pre-authorisation required in 5 business days.
- CIVIC-BASE: Covered; pre-authorisation required in 5 business days.

5.3 `ORTH-ARTH` | Knee Arthroscopy (Procedure | List Price: $6,200 | Duration: 75 minutes)
- MERIDIAN-GOLD: Covered; pre-authorisation required in 2 business days.
- MERIDIAN-SILVER: Covered; pre-authorisation required in 3 business days.
- MERIDIAN-BRONZE: Covered; pre-authorisation required in 5 business days.
- CIVIC-BASE: Not covered.

SECTION 6: EXCEPTIONS AND ESCALATIONS

6.1 Any request to bypass pre-authorisation timelines set out in Section 5 must be submitted in writing to the Revenue Cycle Operations Committee, chaired by Operations Policy Lead Marcus Vance.

6.2 Emergency schedule overrides for `ORTH-ARTH` must be authorised by the attending orthopaedic surgeon and the site nursing supervisor on duty.